EUROPEAN **YOUTH** PARLIAMENT
ITALIA ITALY

VERONA 2026

Resolution Booklet



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General Assembly Procedure
Verona 2026

Approx 45 minutes

General Structure

1. Presenting the Committee topic
2. Silent reading of the resolution (1 min)
3. Defence Speech (3 min)
4. Position Speeches + Instant Response (2 speeches, 2 responses + 2 min
5. each) Round of Debate (2 rounds of 12 min, half of the Committee per
6. round) Summation Speech (3 min)
7. Voting

1. Presenting the Committee topic (1 min)

An Academic Board Member will read the Committee topic out loud.

2. Silent reading of the resolution (1 min)

Delegates have 1 minute to read through the motion for a resolution.

3. Defence Speech (3 min)

One Delegate from the Proposing Committee approaches the podium and delivers a speech presenting the resolution to the General Assembly. The Defence Speech should achieve the following:

- **Introduce the topic**: provide its context, explain why this particular issue is important and why it must be resolved, and lay out the rationale behind the problems.
- **Defend the solutions**: argue rationally and factually why the “by clauses” are both sufficient and necessary to solve the issue, and why the rest of delegates should be in favour of the resolution.

4. Position Speeches + Instant Responses (10 min)

Alternating sides, each speech is delivered from the podium and immediately followed by a direct response delivered by the Defending Committee from the floor before the next speech starts.

Each position speech presents the Delegates' fundamental position on the resolution as a whole, whether in agreement or in disagreement, with an elaboration of the rationale behind it. The speech should address the general approach and spirit of the resolution rather than pick at individual clauses or details, and should use concrete points as examples. If a speech focuses on a single clause, the Board may dismiss it because it is too close to the concept of a point of the

Round of Debate. Delegates are asked to keep the speeches constructive and to mention both negative and positive aspects, as they see it, of the motion for a resolution as a whole.

Segment	Time	Description
Speech 1	2 min	Position Speech from the podium.
Instant Response	2 min	Instant Response: moderator calls the Proposing Committee for a delegate to answer after the speech from the floor.
Speech 2	2 min	Position Speech from the podium.
Instant Response	2 min	Same format as above.

5. Rounds of Debate (25 min)

Four designated delegates go to the podium to defend; the remaining delegates of the committee, as well as the chair, are on the floor. The floor asks one question at a time; whichever defender has the best answer takes it. At the end of the first round, the delegates of the defending committee switch and the second round begins.

Each round will last approximately 12 minutes, with there being no limit on the number of questions or points being made throughout the round.

Points can express approval or disapproval with an “aim statement”, a “because clause” or a “by clause” (with the reasoning behind it), and (recommendably) propose a way to improve a clause that they think does not solve the problem effectively. Points should aim to be concise and direct, lasting a maximum of around 30 seconds. Try to refrain from discussing and bringing up points which were already mentioned. Points are delivered **from the floor**. Chairpersons are asked to keep their placards raised during the round of open debate as long as the Committee desires to deliver a point and whilst the point itself is being delivered.

When a Committee is recognised by the Board, the Delegate will stand up and present their point, speaking to a microphone from the floor. **A maximum of one clause per point may be mentioned; after that, you will be cut off by the Board**.
Each point is answered separately.

6. Summation Speech (3 min)

One or two Delegates from the Proposing Committee approach the podium and deliver a speech summing up the discussion and responding to any points that may not have been yet answered. The Summation Speech should be a presentation of rhetorical energy and skill to convince the General Assembly to vote in favour of their resolution; thus, this speech can be more emotional than rational, primarily aiming to convince other Delegates. No Direct Responses are allowed.

7. Voting

The Chairpersons will gather the votes from the Committees and present them to the Board. The possible voting options are positive (Vote in Favour), negative (Vote Against) or empty (Abstention). All Delegates are encouraged to vote; Abstention should only be used in cases of a serious moral impediment to express one's opinion. It will also be marked if a Delegate is not present (Absent).
A resolution passes if it receives a simple majority of positive votes (more than 50%). In case of a tie, there will be a revote, with abstaining Delegates further encouraged to reconsider their positions.

Each Chairperson will announce the votes once called upon by the Board in the following order: In Favour, Against, Abstaining, Absent.

Rules and Placards

General Rules

- A Delegate's wish to speak should be communicated to their Chairperson.
- The Chairperson (or a Committee Delegate) has to raise the Committee placard for the Committee to be recognised. The Chairperson is responsible for the order of speakers within the Committee.
- Delegates should afford equal respect to all debates as if they were their own.
- Delegates are expected to approach the debates in a respectful and friendly manner.
- The authority of the Academic Board is absolute.

• To keep the environment inclusive, loud clapping is only permitted after the voting results have been announced. To express enthusiasm, all participants are encouraged to use silent clapping/jazz hands. During the Rapid-Fire Open Debate, Committees are asked not to show enthusiasm in a loud manner, but rather to use their creativity to gain the attention of the Board.

• Delegates must always state their name, committee and school before an intervention.

• When speaking, it is highly recommended to maintain a clear and paced voice to ensure the point is well understood by the audience.

Committee Placard

Each Committee has a placard with its Committee acronym. Raising it indicates that the Committee wants attention towards something. Raised alone, it means the Committee is ready to be recognised by the Board. If the placard is not raised, the Board will not recognise the Committee.

Direct Response

Direct Responses (DRs) play a supporting role in this procedure. They are available only during the Round of Debates, and each Committee may use a maximum of 2 Direct Responses per round. When a Committee raises the Direct Response placard, the Board will ask whether the point is
directly related to the last point made. If yes, the Committee is recognised immediately and may jump the queue. If not, the Committee will not be recognised.

- The content of a DR must immediately refer to, follow up, answer or challenge the preceding point, not just be vaguely thematically related, and it should be kept short.
- A DR cannot be answered with another DR.
- The defenders answer a DR like any other question.
- The Board has the freedom to deny, interrupt or disregard Direct Responses at all times.
- DRs shall not be used after the Proposing Committee is recognised to respond to the previous point.

Point of Personal Privilege

Raising this placard is a request to the Board to ask a Delegate to repeat a point that was inaudible, for technical reasons or because it was spoken too quietly. Failure to understand the vocabulary being spoken or to adequately listen and pay attention does not warrant a Point of Personal Privilege.

Point of Order

This placard may only be raised by the Chairperson if the Committee believes the Board has not adequately followed the General Assembly procedure, for instance, if the wrong Committee or the wrong element of the debate was announced. For time reasons, Committees are asked to raise Points of Order as soon as possible so the error can be corrected.

MOTION FOR A RESOLUTION BY THE COMMITTEE ON REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT (REGI)

***Cultural Renaissance**: As many European regions face economic decline, rural depopulation and the loss of traditional cultural practices, local arts and culture can be increasingly promoted as tools for regional revitalisation. How can the EU use local arts and culture to revitalise regions without compromising sustainability and cultural authenticity?*

Submitted by: Sofia BOBBO (IT), Anna Aisha BOSO (IT), Quintilla CAVALLARI (IT), Alessia DOMI (IT), Sebastian KELLNER (AT), Princes Omenaa OBENG (GH/IT), Kamilla SONNEVEND (AT), Romal WARNAKULASURIYA (LK), Christian ZAMBON (IT), Tao Jan TULGA (Chairperson, CY)

The European Youth Parliament aims to revitalise rural areas by promoting arts and local traditions, to raise awareness among young people of their possibilities beyond urban centres. Furthermore, it aims to reanimate and preserve local communities by redirecting the current pressing situation towards a future of economic and cultural growth,

because

A. Local cultural identity and traditions are fading away due to urbanisation, with frequent cultural participation in the EU dropping by around 20% between 2015 and 2022,

B. Only 20% of Europeans aged 16-64 live in rural areas, where higher youth unemployment and economic stagnation threaten a further future depopulation,

C. There is a lack of interest in traditional art and practices, particularly among younger individuals,

D. Globalisation[1] is contributing to a weakening sense of cultural identity and belonging among inhabitants of rural communities,

[1] Globalisation refers to the interconnectedness and interdependence of economies, societies, cultures, and political systems worldwide.

E. Rural exodus[2] is increasing the pressure on territorial cohesion by weakening local communities and regions,

F. Financial instability is driving young artists to abandon their artistic careers in favour of more conventional employment;

by

1. Calling upon the European Committee of the Regions (CoR), in cooperation with NGOs such as Europa Nostra, to foster a sustainable rural economy that retains its local character, without undergoing excessive urbanisation, by incentivising festivals and cultural activities in rural areas;

2. Urging the Directorate-General for Employment, Social Affairs and Inclusion (DG EMPL) to foster job creation in rural regions to build and work on local social infrastructure;

3. Appealing to Member States' National Ministries for Education to promote the consumption of traditional art and practices among youth through the creation of informative programmes within schools;

4. Calling upon the Directorate-General for Regional and Urban Policy (DG REGIO) to increase awareness of cultural heritage within the European population by funding digital training for artisans;

5. Urging the European Leader Association for Rural Development (ELARD) to reduce inequalities between urban and rural areas, combat rural depopulation, and strengthen territorial cohesion through:

    a) support to local businesses, start-ups, and craftsmanship, while offering incentives to creative professions that involve young people in rural areas,

    b) Investments in high-speed internet, healthcare, cultural events, and education to ensure that rural residents have access to services comparable to those available in cities;

[2] Rural exodus is the mass displacement of the rural population to cities. This is an internal migration movement that typically affects young people, both men and women, who move to cities in search of employment.

6. Encouraging the Directorate-General for Education, Youth, Sport and Culture (DG EAC) to expand programmes, such as Creative Europe or Culture Moves Europe, that support independent artists both financially and through the organisation of galleries, allowing them to showcase their work to larger audiences;

7. Calling upon the DG EMPL, in coordination with the European Alliance for Apprenticeships, to promote the creation and extension of apprenticeships in rural areas.

MOTION FOR A RESOLUTION BY THE SPECIAL COMMITTEE ON ORGANISED CRIME, CORRUPTION, AND MONEY LAUNDERING (CRIM)

High Stakes: *Europe's drug market is rapidly expanding, valued at over EUR 30 billion annually and fuelling organised crime, with record drug seizures reflecting an increasing demand. As trafficking networks become more sophisticated and cross-border, how can the EU strengthen its response to drug trafficking while safeguarding fundamental rights?*

Submitted by: Fani Ado ASKARIDOU (GR), Beatrice BOTTINI (IT), Matteo FADINI (IT), Jeevanjot KAUR (IT), Kristel LAKAJ (IT), Sara MANJLI (IT), Elena MOROSINI (IT), Lisa STANDER (IT), Francesca VESCOVI (IT), Julio WIESER (AT), Pablo SILVÁN (Chairperson, ES)

The European Youth Parliament aims to reduce both the demand and supply of illicit drugs in the EU by combining prevention and awareness policies with stronger action against drug trafficking. It also aims to limit the influence of organised crime groups (OCGs), money laundering and corruption on European society. It further aims to create a more coordinated Union, in which Member States and EU authorities align their efforts against cross-border trafficking,

because

A. OCGs recruit minors as young as 12, due to their vulnerability and the lighter legal consequences they may face compared with adults,

B. Member States' policies regarding exploited minors remain heterogeneous, with some protecting them as victims and others prosecuting them as offenders,

C. Insufficient information exchange and cooperation between national law enforcement authorities hinder the dismantling of cross-border drug trafficking networks,

D. Framework Decision 2004/757/JHA, the EU's main law against drug trafficking, dates from 2004 and has only been partially updated, failing to reflect modern trafficking methods,

E. OCGs hide their profits in the legal economy by taking advantage of gaps in the financial oversight of Member States,

F. Many young Europeans lack sufficient information about the health and social consequences of drug use, which may contribute to demand for illicit drugs,

G. Only 2-10% of the over 90 million containers entering EU ports each year are physically inspected,

H. Traffickers increasingly shift their operations to smaller ports with weaker security controls,

I. OCGs bribe port workers, customs officials, and law enforcement authorities in order to move, undetected, drug shipments through EU ports,

J. Investigative tools such as the interception of encrypted communications raise concerns regarding the right to privacy and the proportionality of enforcement measures;

by

1. Recommending Member States to set up social programmes in neighbourhoods at high risk of recruitment, offering minors educational and leisure alternatives to involvement with OCGs;

2. Urging Member States to treat minors exploited by OCGs primarily as victims by involving child protection services rather than the criminal justice system,

3. Inviting Member States to make greater use of Joint Investigation Teams, supported by Europol and Eurojust, to counter cross-border drug trafficking operations;

4. Encouraging Member States to offer incentives to OCG members who provide information to the authorities, such as:

    a) providing access to witness protection programmes,

    b) offering financial protection for relocation and reintegration,

    c) reducing sentences proportionate to the value of the information provided;

5. Calling upon the Directorate-General for Migration and Home Affairs (DG HOME) to propose a revision of Framework Decision 2004/757/JHA to:

    a) update its definitions to cover modern trafficking methods, such as the use of encrypted communications and online sales,

    b) further harmonise the level of penalties for drug trafficking offences across Member States,

    c) establish the recruitment of minors as an aggravating circumstance, imposing heavier penalties on responsible adults;

6. Urging Member States to ensure full compliance with the EU rules on asset recovery and confiscation to seize the profits of drug trafficking, and to reinvest them in prevention programmes;

7. Calling upon the DG HOME to improve drug detection at the EU's borders by:

    a) increasing funding for research into detection technologies through the Security Research and Innovation Campus,

    b) supporting the European Ports Alliance in extending container-scanning equipment and security standards to smaller ports;

8. Calling upon Member States to combat corruption in ports and customs authorities by:

    a) designating them as priority sectors in national anti-corruption strategies under Directive (EU) 2026/1021,

    b) introducing regular background checks and staff rotation for employees in sensitive positions;

9. Calls upon Member States to ensure that the interception of encrypted communications in drug trafficking investigations is subject to judicial authorisation and independent oversight, with clear limitations on its duration and scope;

10. Asking the European Union Agency for Fundamental Rights (FRA) to assess the impact on the right to privacy of the investigative tools used against drug trafficking, including the interception of encrypted communications;

11. Asking the European Union Drugs Agency to create an accessible online platform for young people, offering reliable information on the health and social consequences of drug use.

MOTION FOR A RESOLUTION BY THE COMMITTEE ON AGRICULTURAL AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT (AGRI)

Land for the Next Generations: *With nearly 1 in 3 EU farmers over 65 and only 11% under 40, combined with rising land prices, urban sprawl, and increasing concentration of farmland in large agribusiness holdings, access to land has become the biggest barrier for young farmers entering the sector. How can the EU ensure young farmers have access to land to grow crops and promote family farming and local food systems?*

Submitted by: Aurora BRACCIANTINI (IT), Maria CHORTAREA (GR), Katie Ann DEVANEY (IE), Alessandro DINDO (IT), Riccardo Giorgio FINI (IT), Martino FIORIO (IT), Tommaso GARBIN (IT), Vittoria MARZOCCHI (IT), Asia NOGARA (IT), Gaia PIRAN (IT), Patrizia IVAN (Chairperson, IT)

The European Youth Parliament aims to make land more accessible to young farmers and to promote agricultural education, believing in the legacy of family farms. It also aims to establish efficient development guidelines and funds for farmers across Europe to incentivise the implementation of modern agricultural tools and technologies. It further aims to prevent environmental hazards across Europe and to increase sustainable productivity by supporting sustainable agricultural practices,

because

A. Financial hurdles and relatively diminished investment through the Common Agricultural Policy (CAP) hinder young farmers from accessing farmland,

B. Declining education about the agricultural sector, limited agricultural policy literacy, and low engagement in farming careers can hinder generational renewal[3],

C. There is an increasing lack of education on the agricultural sector and of policy literacy, coupled with the fact that farming is rarely viewed as a modern career choice,

[3] Generation renewal refers to the transition of land, assets, and operational leadership from outgoing farmers to younger ones or new entrants. It describes the process of replacing an ageing workforce with new, younger entrants to ensure agricultural survival, innovation and sustainability.

D. Lenient regulatory standards and legal sanctions in agricultural hazardous practices complicate the enforcement of sustainable behaviour, often resulting in environmental harm,

E. Speculative investment in farmland can remove land from agricultural use, reducing investment in new technologies and sustainable agricultural practices,

F. Declining demand for local food products in favour of large retailers threatens the economic viability of family farms,

G. Limited investment in sustainable agritech research hinders local farmers' ability to modernise and adapt their agricultural practices,

H. The number of operating farms in the EU is expected to drastically decrease over the years, as only 12% of farmers are currently under the age of 40;

by

1. Encouraging the European Council of Young Farmers (CEJA) to strengthen their advocacy at both EU and national levels to ensure an appropriate representation of young farmers in policymaking;

2. Requesting that Member States promote the integration of agricultural studies in secondary education through extracurricular initiatives, interactive courses and practical workshops;

3. Urging the Directorate-General for Agriculture and Rural Development (DG AGRI) to establish stronger protocols for sustainable agricultural practices, accompanied by stricter penalties to ensure compliance;

4. Encouraging Member States to support farmers in meeting CAP requirements and accessing the financial support available under the framework to promote practices such as precision farming[4];

5. Urges Member States to streamline administrative procedures for small-scale producers selling directly to consumers in local markets and community spaces;

[4] Precision farming involves using data-driven technology to improve farming outcomes.

6. Recommending Member States to promote agricultural cooperatives to ensure the long-term continuity of local farms and strengthen their collective bargaining power with large retailers;

7. Calling upon DG AGRI to increase CAP financial support for young farmers and sustainable agricultural practices;

8. Further calling upon DG AGRI to strengthen the monitoring and transparency of CAP funding and publish annual data on farmland prices and ownership concentration across the EU;

9. Urging Member States to strengthen their monitoring of agricultural land transfers to prevent market speculation and promote fair access to farmland.

MOTION FOR A RESOLUTION BY THE COMMITTEE ON INDUSTRY, RESEARCH AND ENERGY (ITRE)

***Going with the Flow**: While hydroelectric plants generate 30% of all renewable energy in the EU, their potential is held back by ageing infrastructure and tightening environmental constraints. How can the EU modernise and expand its hydropower sector in a way that is both sustainable and fit for the green energy transition?*

Submitted by: Enrico AIELLI (IT), Martino CAPITTI (IT), Giulianna Marie CELEBERTTI LACAYO (IT), Alice COGO (IT), Erik CORDIOLI (IT), Marco GALIAZZO (IT), Jera JEZERŠEK (SI), Tiziano LONGO (IT), Benjamin Nikolai NURMI (SE), Emma ZANELLA (IT), Batu BÖLÜKEMİNİ (Chairperson, TR)

The European Youth Parliament aims to support the green energy transition, ensuring the expansion and modernisation of the EU's hydroelectric sector while preserving biodiversity and environmental stability. Thus, it aims to resolve legislative contradictions within the EU's frameworks for energy production and ecological protection, focus the allocation of funds towards upgrading ageing infrastructure, and facilitate communication on common goals between NGOs and the EU, increasing public benefit,

because

A. Hydroelectric dams trap sediment in reservoirs, substantially severing the connectivity of streams, blocking fish migration, and flooding forests and habitats,

B. Existing conflicts regarding renewable energy expansion and freshwater biodiversity protection between more than 150 NGOs and the EU prevent the construction of new hydropower projects,

C. Member States fail to meet renewable energy targets due to the contradicting directives regarding hydropower between the Renewable Energy Directive and the Water Framework Directive,

D. The lack of flowing money[5] prevents the modernisation of pre-existing outdated infrastructures and the construction of new ones,

E. The progressive degradation of ageing hydroelectric infrastructure significantly contributes to diminished generation efficiency and overall capacity,

F. Differing policies applied by Member States regarding hydroelectric plants lead to confusing initiatives towards hydroelectric regimes;

by

1. Calling upon the Directorate-General for Environment (DG ENV) to coordinate with Member States in the construction of fish passages and ecological bypasses in hydropower plants to:

    a) ensure the safe migration of migratory species,

    b) preserve the biodiversity in affected areas;

2. Urging the Directorate-General for Energy (DG ENER) to hold an annual forum to promote the exchange of ideas on the modernisation and expansion of hydroelectric infrastructure;

3. Calling upon the DG ENV and DG ENER to establish a joint strategy which ensures both ecological protection and energy production goals, increasing hydroelectric energy production while respecting the Water Framework Directive;

4. Calling upon DG ENV to safeguard surrounding ecosystems and biodiversity by ensuring that hydroelectric modernisation and construction plans comply with EU environmental legislation;

5. Calling upon the DG ENER, in collaboration with the European Investment Bank, to incentivise investment in new hydropower projects aimed at maximising the energy-generation potential and efficiency of the plants;

6. Calling upon the DG ENER to establish a regulatory expert panel to identify and evaluate outdated infrastructure and ensure that the maximum potential of energy is reached;

[5] Flowing money is the active capital and liquidity continually invested into public works.

7. Urging the Directorate-General for Communication (DG COMM) to raise public awareness of the benefits of hydropower energy through information campaigns, interactive workshops and seminars accessible to all citizens.

MOTION FOR A RESOLUTION BY THE COMMITTEE ON CIVIL LIBERTIES, JUSTICE AND HOME AFFAIRS (LIBE)

Swipe Fatigue: *As concerns grow over the impact of digital dependency and excessive screen time on young people's mental health and social development, these habits are increasingly shaping how younger generations interact with the world around them. How can the EU promote healthier digital habits whilst encouraging meaningful engagement with local communities, cultures and traditions?*

Submitted by: Óscar AIGHOBAHI (ES), Greta BOULIS (IT), Giulia MAZZI (IT), Edda MENEGHELLI (IT), Isa MOBERG (SE), Eleonora PAONE (IT), Lucia SEGA (IT), Carolina ANDRADE (Chairperson, PT)

The European Youth Parliament aims to reduce social media addiction among young Europeans, adopting appropriate regulatory measures to safeguard the physical and psychological well-being of EU citizens. It furthermore aims not to ban social media, but to promote a balanced and responsible approach to its use,

because

A. Social media addiction has caused a decrease in concentration among youth,

B. The growing use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) is diminishing critical thinking abilities and creative skills among young individuals,

C. Modern global social media trends have caused a major loss of local culture,

D. Excessive social media usage leads to mental health outcomes, including depression and anxiety,

E. The increasingly frequent and constant use of technological devices is leading to growing inactivity and physical health problems, such as eyesight problems,

F. Digital addiction has caused a decline in social interaction skills,

G. 1 in 6 adolescents have experienced cyberbullying, which can lead to an increase in anxiety and stress;

by

1. Urging the Directorate-General for Communications Networks, Content and Technology (DG CONNECT) to require Very Large Online Platforms (VLOPs) to implement default mechanisms that restrict access to social media applications after excessive time usage;

2. Calling upon the Member States' National Ministries for Education to promote into school curricula the integration of AI-related literacy activities;

3. Authorising the European Centre for Algorithmic Transparency (ECAT) to encourage the development of location-sensitive social media algorithms to display content to users according to their geographical locations;

4. Calling on public authorities to fund cultural events that promote cultural awareness, and to encourage attendance through interactive social media campaigns;

5. Encouraging the Directorate-General for Education, Youth, Sport and Culture (DG EAC) to promote physical activity and a healthier balance between screen time and exercise by:

    a) launching an application that introduces movement-based breaks and activity reminders,

    b) encouraging sports-related campaigns that motivate young people to participate in physical activities;

6. Urging the Directorate-General for Health and Food Safety (DG SANTE) to strengthen the prevention of social media-related mental health risks among young people by:

    a) implementing interactive psychoeducation workshops,

    b) implementing practical coping toolkits that teach students to recognise anxiety triggers,

    c) promoting self-regulation techniques, such as setting daily time limits on social media use;

7. Inviting the DG EAC to encourage healthier smartphone habits among young people by:

a) promoting phone locker boxes during study sessions, group work, and family meals,

b) supporting Member States that decide to introduce phone-free areas in schools;

8. Designating the DG CONNECT to enhance platform accountability and protect minors from cyberbullying by granting researchers access to anonymised moderation data and promoting rights-respecting algorithms that detect harassment patterns.

MOTION FOR A RESOLUTION BY
THE COMMITTEE ON LEGAL AFFAIRS (JURI)

Killing the puppets: *With corporations spending €380 million annually on lobbying the EU and watchdog organisations speaking out against the apparent lack of transparency in some European institutions, concerns over corporate influence on policy-making continue to grow. In view of this, how should the EU work with outside organisations to create a Union where democratic processes are respected and valued?*

Submitted by: Adriana Daria BRAILEANU (IT), Lorcan DIAMOND (IE), Andrés GALERA MARTÍNEZ (ES), Adrian GANUZA SCHÖFL (ES), Elouisa-Sophie HASSELGREN (SE), Micol MIDOSSI (IT), Francesca SIMEONE (IT), Benedetta VACCARO (IT), Riccardo ZARDINI (IT), Nina ZEN (IT), Alba TENESA NAVARRO (Chairperson, UK)

The European Youth Parliament aims to establish a more transparent and balanced EU policymaking process by ensuring that no individual company can exert disproportionate influence over public policy. It seeks to create a more equal balance of power between companies. Furthermore, it aims to regulate foreign influence within EU lobbying while amplifying the power of non-governmental organisations in decision-making to create a more equal system,

because

A. The European Union Transparency Register (EUTR) and other transparency measures are insufficient to ensure effective oversight of lobbying activities,

B. The information reported to the EUTR by lobbying groups is subject to limited verification and is often inaccurate,

C. Large corporations outspend small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) on lobbying, creating an influence gap that can result in unequal representation in policymaking,

D. Corporate interests are frequently put first over democratic values and social and environmental protections in EU policymaking,

E. Large foreign-owned corporations hold a disproportionate influence over EU policies and institutions, potentially undermining EU citizens' interests,

F. Risks of political corruption persist in interactions between the EU's institutions and lobbyists,

G. Large corporations spend between EUR 3-8 million annually on external lobbying services registered in the EUTR that may not be reflected in their reported in-house lobbying expenditure;

by

1. Encouraging the relevant EU institutions[6] to reinforce lobbying regulations by expanding the legal framework of the EUTR;

2. Calling upon the Secretariat-General of the European Commission to propose legislation establishing a legally binding framework setting up a monitoring mechanism that oversees lobbying transparency and enforces scaled financial penalties for non-compliance according to corporate size;

3. Inviting the Secretariat-General of the European Commission to implement a financial cap regarding big corporations' expenditures in lobbying;

4. Calling upon the Secretariat-General of the European Commission to propose legislation establishing a minimum proportion between lobbying activities conducted by European and foreign lobbies, thus prioritising European markets and interests;

5. Inviting the European Anti-Fraud Office (OLAF) to launch a larger range of independent investigations as well as stronger sanctions;

6. Suggesting that the Secretariat-General of the European Commission broaden the definition of "lobbying" to include law firms and consultancies;

7. Calling upon Member States to introduce sanctions for organisations that fail to fully disclose their in-house lobbying expenditure.

[6] In this case, the European Commission, the European Parliament and the Council of the European Union are the competent bodies to implement a change in a shared, interinstitutional instrument governed directly by them such as the EU Transparency Register (EUTR).

MOTION FOR A RESOLUTION BY THE COMMITTEE ON SECURITY AND DEFENCE (SEDE)

***Standing Guard**: As global conflicts escalate and the reliability of long-standing alliances such as NATO increasingly comes into question, the EU finds itself exposed by decades of underinvestment in defence and an over-reliance on external security guarantees. In view of this, how can the EU strengthen its shared defence policy and foster cooperation between Member States to ensure its own security and strategic autonomy?*

Submitted by: Francesca AMENDOLA (IT), Silvia CERPELLONI (IT), Margherita COSTELLATO (IT), Angelina KUZAI D'AMBRONZO (IT), Luca LOVATO (IT), Riccardo POL (IT), Emma SALANI (IT), Emma SALIZZONI (IT), Sima TRJMAN (SE), Sathmi WARNAKULASURIYA (IT), Emma BELLERI (Chairperson, IT)

The European Youth Parliament aims to strengthen strategic cooperation and cohesion among the Member States while reducing external economic dependencies that limit the EU's strategic autonomy,

because

A. Economic, legal and strategic fragmentation among Member States hinders the development of a common European approach to defence,

B. Unanimity voting[7] requirements in EU institutions such as the Council of the European Union and the European Council limit rapid and coordinated decision-making,

C. Differences in the EU and the NATO membership can complicate coordination and synergies between the two organisations,

D. Poor coordination between Member States and EU institutions leads to a lack of shared defence policies, competing priorities, and a weak global perception of the EU's military strength,

[7] Unanimity voting is a decision-making method where a proposal, motion, or election is approved only if every single voter agrees without any dissenting votes.

E. Strengthening the European defence budget increases military expenditure and diverts resources away from other sectors, such as social welfare,

F. Outsourcing the production of defence manufacturing weakens the EU's industry and economic growth, as well as its ability to develop an autonomous defence and security system,

G. The weak sense of belonging to the EU diminishes the willingness of Member States to contribute to common defence initiatives and undermines the EU's cohesion;

by

1. Calling upon Member States to use the Permanent Structured Cooperation (PESCO) to develop common defence priorities and objectives to reduce fragmentation in the EU's defence policy;

2. Urging the European Council to expand the use of qualified majority voting[8] in foreign and security policymaking to facilitate more efficient decision-making;

3. Encouraging Member States to raise awareness about the importance of cooperation and solidarity between Member States regarding defence policies by incentivising schools to promote educational programmes about the EU, such as EYP's affiliated programme Understanding Europe;

4. Urging the European External Action Service (EEAS) to ensure coherence in the EU's foreign policy and increase its ability to act more efficiently during critical situations;

5. Requesting that the European Commission allocate a needs-based budget for defence expenditure, while safeguarding financial resources for key policy areas, such as social welfare, healthcare, and education;

6. Encouraging Member States to reassess their expenditures on military deployments abroad and redirect funds towards internal programmes, safeguarding both European security and welfare;

[8] Qualified minority voting is a decision-making system that allows resolutions to pass without requiring unanimous agreement. A qualified majority is reached if two conditions are simultaneously met: at least 55% of Member States vote in favour (15 out of 27) and those Member States represent at least 65% of the total EU population.

7. Urging the European Commission to prioritise EU-made products in both external and internal trade and use existing European Defence Fund (EDF) resources for industrial research, strengthening economic and military independence.

MOTION FOR A RESOLUTION BY THE COMMITTEE ON CULTURE AND EDUCATION (CULT)

Excuse my French: *According to UNESCO's Atlas of the World's Languages in Danger, 128 languages within the EU are considered to be endangered. Considering this, how can the EU secure the preservation and promotion of regional and minority languages while also ensuring cultural integration within the Member States?*

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The European Youth Parliament believes people should have the right to use their native language freely in all aspects of daily life. It further aims to protect and maintain Regional and Minority Languages (RMLs). It finally aims to preserve the EU's cultural heritage by safeguarding the identities, traditions, and customs connected to these languages,

because

A. The preservation of RMLs can be perceived as detrimental to national cohesion and integration,

B. Lingua francas[9] are often favoured due to their perceived economic and professional value, disincentivising the intergenerational transmission of RMLs,

C. Young speakers are discouraged from using RMLs in their daily lives due to social stigmatisation,

D. Migration to urban centres can reduce the everyday use of RMLs, as speakers increasingly rely on dominant languages[10],

[9] Lingua franca are languages which are widely recognised and understood within the international community, such as English, French, or Spanish.
[10] A dominant language is the language in which an individual, particularly a bilingual adult or infant, performs best across various language tasks.

E. Lack of teaching materials, linguistic standardisation and qualified teachers reinforces limited access to education in RMLs,

F. RMLs are underrepresented in culture and media, not having content available on mainstream digital platforms;

by

1. Calling upon the European Cultural Foundation (ECF) to support the connection of RML communities through cross-border cultural exchanges and events;

2. Asking Member States to promote participation in initiatives such as the Rise Up Project to counteract the stigmatisation of RMLs and promote linguistic diversity;

3. Urging the Directorate-General for Education, Youth, Sport and Culture (DG EAC) to financially support cultural events such as festivals and local fairs in areas where endangered languages are spoken;

4. Calling upon Member States' National Ministries for Education to foster RML education alongside the national language programmes through the promotion of bilingual learning modules;

5. Encouraging Member States to support the creation and improvement of RML official academies to foster the standardisation of the languages, teacher training and the development of learning materials;

6. Encouraging Member States to provide financial incentives to companies and educational institutions that actively promote and support the use of RMLs;

7. Recommending the European Language Equality Network (ELEN) to further improve the digital representation of endangered languages by strengthening the Digital Language Diversity Project.

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